

Nejat Gökhan Okatan

University of Milano-Bicocca
nejatgokhan.okatan@unimib.it <https://nejatokatan.github.io>

Research Fields: Banking, Corporate Finance, International Economics, Labor Economics

Current Position

2024– **Postdoctoral Researcher**, University of Milano-Bicocca

Education

2018–2024 **Ph.D. in Business Economics** (joint degree), KU Leuven & Ghent University

2017–2018 **Advanced Master's in Economics**, KU Leuven

2010–2012 **M.Sc. in Economics**, Tilburg University

2009–2010 **Exchange Student in Economics**, Tilburg University

2008–2010 **Minor in Mathematics**, Middle East Technical University

2006–2010 **B.Sc. in Economics**, Middle East Technical University

Publications

1. “The Real Effects of Banks’ Corporate Credit Supply: A Literature Review,” with O. Güler, M. Mariathan, & K. Mulier. *Economic Inquiry*, 59(3), 1252–1285, 2021.

Working Papers

1. “Sovereign Defaults and Trade: External vs. Domestic Creditors” (with D. Essers & S. Marchesi). Revise and Resubmit, *Journal of International Economics*.
2. “How Credit Availability and Production Technologies Shape Hiring: Evidence from a Plant Closure” (with M. Mariathan & K. Mulier).

Work in Progress

1. “Mass Layoffs, Re-employment Preferences, and Firm Outcomes” (with M. Mariathan & K. Mulier).
2. “Sovereign Defaults, Bank Ownership, and Lending Outcomes” (with S. Marchesi & U. Panizza).

Awards and Honors

2018–2024 **PhD Scholarship & Fellowship**, KU Leuven

2018, 2019 **Welcome Speech to Graduate Students**, KU Leuven

2010–2012 **Master's Scholarship & Fee Waiver**, Tilburg University

2009–2010 **Erasmus Exchange Grant**, Middle East Technical University

2008 **Congratulations of the Rector; Top Student**, Middle East Technical University

2006–2010 **Dean's Highest Honors List; Scholarship for Outstanding Academic Performance**, Middle East Technical University

2005 **Ranked top 0.1%**, Turkish Nationwide University Entrance Exam

2004 **Selected Participant**, National Mathematics Olympiads

Extra Training

2026 **Journal of International Economics Summer School**, Bocconi University

2026 **Agentic Coding Workshop**, University of Milano-Bicocca

Seminar Organization

2026–2027 **DEMS ReLunch Seminars (with G. Antonicchia)**, University of Milano-Bicocca

2025–2026 **DEMS ReLunch Seminars (with G. Antonicchia)**, University of Milano-Bicocca

Conference Presentations

2026 PDM Conference* (OECD), Workshop on Sovereign Debt (Milano-Bicocca), DEMS ReLunch (Milano-Bicocca)

2025 DebtCON* (Georgetown); CefES Conference (Milano-Bicocca); ETSG Conference (Politecnico di Milano); Workshop on Sovereign Debt (Milano-Bicocca); DEMS ReLunch (Milano-Bicocca)

2024 Corporate Finance Day* (KU Leuven); DGF Conference* (RWTH Aachen); BFRF Meeting (National Bank of Belgium); EALE Conference* (NHH Bergen); IWH-FIN-FIRE Workshop* (IWH Halle); Finance Seminars* (Ghent); KU Leuven Seminars (KU Leuven)

2023 AFSE Meeting (Sciences Po); KU Leuven Seminars (KU Leuven); World Finance Conference (Online)

*by co-authors

Teaching Experience

2025–2026 **International Financial Markets**, University of Milano-Bicocca

2024–2026 **Principles of Economics**, University of Milano-Bicocca

2018–2024 **MSc Thesis Supervision**, KU Leuven

2009–2010 **Statistics for Economists II**, Middle East Technical University

2008–2009 **Introduction to Research Methods I & II**, Middle East Technical University

Policy Experience

2013–2017 **Policy Officer**, Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey

Language and Software Skills

Languages: Turkish (native), English (fluent)

Software: Cursor, Stata, R, L^AT_EX

References

Prof. Silvia Marchesi

University of Milano-Bicocca

Silvia.Marchesi@unimib.it

Prof. Mike Mariathan

KU Leuven

Mike.Mariathan@kuleuven.be

Prof. Ugo Panizza

Geneva Graduate Institute

Ugo.Panizza@graduateinstitute.ch

Last updated: Sep 2026